

NEW GUIDE

**“How do we
compare?”**

**Reporting social
media to
council.**

Sooner or later a council member or manager asks. Here is how to answer it in a way that holds up.

What to report, and what not to →

WHY THE OBVIOUS ANSWERS FAIL

Followers, a viral post, a raw total.

Follower count mostly measures how big your community is. Your best post is an outlier you can't repeat. A total with no peer set is trivia, not evidence.

LEAD WITH SHARES

56% vs. 34%

of local-government posts earn a share, against 34% that earn a comment. Residents forward civic information more than they debate it. A share is the closest thing to a “this was useful” vote.

COMPARE LIKE WITH LIKE

13 - 20 - 29

posts a month for a typical town under 10,000, a city of 10,000 to 50,000, and a city or county over 50,000. Across those bands, a comparison tells you nothing except how big the places are.

23,167 municipality-months.

READ THE GUIDE

Make the work legible.

One page, ninety seconds: median engagement next to peers your size, your three best posts and why, and one recommendation for next month.

The full guide, with a checklist you can paste into a draft:

govfeeds.com/guides/reporting-to-council